Learning Objective 5.1: I can create a GNU Radio out-of-tree (OOT) module and add a custom Python block to it.

Learning Objective 5.2: I can implement a custom signal-processing block from scratch and integrate it into a GNU Radio flowgraph.

Show your work. Write a **Documentation** line at the end (**None** if you did not collaborate).

1. **The files of a module.** A cadet runs `gr_modtool newmod beacon` and then `gr_modtool add -t sync -l python tone_finder` in the new directory.

   (a) Name the file the cadet edits for each job: (i) the signal processing, (ii) the label and parameters GRC shows, and (iii) the unit test that `ctest` runs.

   (i) the block's `work()`: `python/beacon/tone_finder.py`
   (ii) GRC's view: `grc/beacon_tone_finder.block.yml`
   (iii) the test: `python/beacon/qa_tone_finder.py`

   (b) The cadet builds and installs the module with GNU Radio 3.10.9. `ctest` passes, but a flowgraph that uses the block stops with

   ```
   ModuleNotFoundError: No module named 'gnuradio.beacon.tone_finder'
   ```

   Explain the cause and the fix.

   On 3.10.9, `gr_modtool add` does not add `tone_finder.py` to the `gr_python_install(FILES ...)` line of `python/beacon/CMakeLists.txt`. `ctest` passes because it runs from the build directory's copy of the whole `python/` folder, but the install copies only `__init__.py`. Add `tone_finder.py` to that line, then build and install again.

   (c) After a correct install, GRC's block library still has no `tone_finder`. Give two possible causes.

   GRC was open during the install and has not reloaded its library: restart it. Or the cadet installed the module under a different prefix from the GNU Radio that GRC runs, for example without setting `CMAKE_INSTALL_PREFIX` to the radioconda environment, so the YAML file is not in that environment's `share/gnuradio/grc/blocks`.

2. **Choosing a block type.** For each block below, choose sync, decimator, interpolator, or general, and give the ratio of outputs to inputs.

   (a) A block that converts each float sample to dB.

   The block makes one output per input, so it is a sync block, 1:1.

   sync

   (b) A block that outputs the peak magnitude of each run of 100 complex samples.

   The block makes one output per 100 inputs, so it is a decimator with decim = 100.

   decimator, 100

   (c) A block that holds each bit for 8 samples.

   The block makes eight outputs per input, so it is an interpolator with interp = 8; Repeat does this job.

   interpolator, 8

   (d) A squelch that passes only the samples whose power is above a threshold and drops the rest.

   The number of outputs per input depends on the signal, so the block must report what it consumed and produced each call: general.

   general

   (e) The Energy Detector could have been a general block. Explain in words what code a decimator lets the programmer leave out.

   As a decimator, the block tells GNU Radio its fixed ratio once, and the scheduler then hands `work()` exactly $n \times N$ inputs for n outputs and consumes them itself. A general block would have to write a `forecast()` function and call `consume()` with the number of inputs used on every call.

3. **Levels.** A cadet runs the Energy Detector on a keyed tone of amplitude 1 at 48 kHz, with GNU Radio's Noise Source at amplitude 0.25, and averages 64 samples.

   (a) Find the power output, in dB, with the carrier off and with it on.

   $P_{\text{off}} = 20 \log_{10} 0.25 = -12.0$ dB

   $P_{\text{on}} = 10 \log_{10}(1 + 0.25^2) = 10 \log_{10} 1.0625 = 0.26$ dB

   off: -12.0 dB

   on: $+0.26$ dB

   (b) Choose a threshold halfway between the two levels in dB.

   $$\frac{-12.0 + 0.26}{2} = -5.9 \text{ dB}$$

   -5.9 dB

   (c) How long does each output cover, and how many outputs does the block make per second?

   $$T = \frac{64}{48{,}000} = 1.33 \text{ ms}$$

   $$\frac{48{,}000}{64} = 750 \text{ outputs per second}$$

   1.33 ms, 750/s

   (d) Averaging N samples divides the spread of the noise power by $\sqrt{N}$. Find the floor's spread as a fraction of its mean, and in dB above and below it.

   $$\frac{1}{\sqrt{64}} = 0.125$$

   $10 \log_{10} 1.125 = +0.51$ dB , $\quad 10 \log_{10} 0.875 = -0.58$ dB

   about ± 0.5 dB

   (e) Suggest a hysteresis and explain the choice in words.

   A hysteresis of about 2 to 3 dB works. That is a few times the floor's spread, so noise near the threshold cannot turn the key back off, and the off level, -8 to -9 dB, still sits 3 dB or more above the floor.

4. **Hysteresis by hand.** The Energy Detector, with its key starting at 0, receives these ten power values in dB:

$$-25,\ -14,\ -16,\ -14,\ -16,\ -14,\ -21,\ -16,\ -14,\ -22$$

(a) Write the ten key outputs for a threshold of -15 dB and a hysteresis of 4 dB, and count the times the key changes.

The key turns on above -15 dB and off below -19 dB, so it reads `0 1 1 1 1 1 0 0 1 0`, with 4 changes.

(b) Repeat for a hysteresis of 0 dB.

The key turns on above -15 dB and off below -15 dB, so it reads `0 1 0 1 0 1 0 0 1 0`, with 8 changes.

(c) The values -14 and -16 dB are noise on a carrier that stays on. Explain in words which key is correct, and what a Morse decoder would make of the other.

The key with 4 dB of hysteresis is correct: it stays on from the first -14 dB until the power drops to -21 dB, when the carrier goes off. Without hysteresis, the key flips at every dip below -15 dB, and a decoder would read one long element as three short ones.

5. **A unit test.** A test feeds the Energy Detector, with 4 samples averaged, a threshold of -10 dB, and a hysteresis of 3 dB, these twelve complex samples:

$$1,\ 1,\ 1,\ 1,\ \ 0.1,\ 0.1,\ 0.1,\ 0.1,\ \ 1,\ 1,\ 0,\ 0$$

(a) How many outputs does each port make? Give the power outputs in dB.

Twelve inputs at 4 per output give 3 outputs.

$$P_1 = 10\log_{10} 1 = 0 \text{ dB}$$
$$P_2 = 10\log_{10} 0.01 = -20 \text{ dB}$$
$$P_3 = 10\log_{10} \tfrac{1+1+0+0}{4} = -3.0 \text{ dB}$$

0, -20, -3.0 dB

(b) Give the three key outputs.

The first output, 0 dB, is above -10 dB, so the key turns on; -20 dB is below -13 dB, so it turns off; -3 dB is above -10 dB, so it turns on again. The key is 1, 0, 1.

1, 0, 1

(c) The last output averages a run where the carrier switched off halfway through. Explain in words what that does to the timing of a key edge, and how the number of samples averaged sets the size of the effect.

The block sees only the average of each run, so an edge inside a run moves to the run's boundary, and the run reads 3 dB down if the carrier was on for half of it. The key's edges are therefore uncertain by up to one output, N/f_s seconds: averaging more samples smooths the floor but blurs the timing.

Documentation: _____